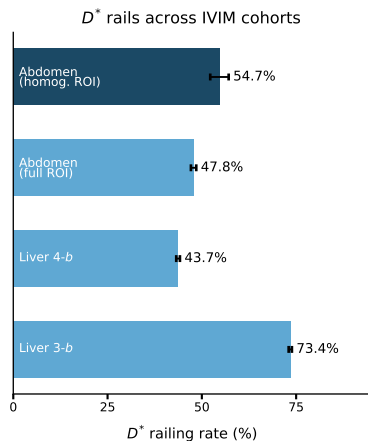




A conventional bounded least-squares IVIM fit rails the pseudo-diffusion coefficient D^* against a parameter bound in 54.7% of high-SNR voxels of an open in-vivo abdomen scan (95% CI [52.2, 57.1]) — an assumption-free, reproducible signature of weak D^* identifiability that recurs at 43.7–73.4% across independent abdomen and liver cohorts. Because the fraction is read directly off the optimiser, it needs no ground truth and is immune to the objection that a calibration claim inherits the trust of its simulator.